



3-Minute Bible Discussion Guide

The Secrecy Motif in Mark

OPENING PRAYER

God of insight and revelation, as we read the ancient words of Scripture, open our minds and hearts to the good news of Jesus in our lives today. Through your Holy Spirit, help us discover the depths of Christ's self-sacrificing love for each of us. In the name of your son Jesus Christ we pray. *Amen.*

SCRIPTURE READINGS

Mark 1:40-45 – [LINK HERE](#)

Mark 3:7-12 - [LINK HERE](#)

Mark 15:33-41 - [LINK HERE](#)

(Read each aloud as a group.)

WATCH VIDEO

3-Minute Bible (“Literary Motifs in the New Testament”) – [LINK HERE](#)

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. In the first passage (Mark 1:40-45), what precedes Jesus's command of secrecy? Does Jesus's command in this passage make sense on its own, or does it raise more questions than answers?
2. The context of Jesus's demand for secrecy in the second passage (Mark 3:7-12) is different than that of the first (Mark 1:40-45). What claim do the unclean spirits make about Jesus? How does Jesus's responsive command for silence challenge the assumption that Jesus's miracles define his identity?
3. How does the third passage (Mark 15:33-41) finally break the pattern of secrecy? How does this shape our understanding of Jesus's identity as God's son? What is the significance of the fact that a Roman centurion, a representative of the empire that crucified Jesus, is the one who gives this testimony?
4. The video explains that literary motifs are intended to help the reader grasp the meaning of Christ's life and death. What does Mark's secrecy motif reveal about how miraculous displays of power, and the surrendering of that very power, define Christ's Lordship?

5. How does the secrecy motif in Mark clarify our own obligations as Christ's disciples? How does Mark challenge the notion that Christ-like discipleship entails the pursuit of results-oriented achievement and the wielding of personal power and influence?

CLOSING PRAYER

Gracious God, we thank you for the wonder and mystery of Scripture. As we go from this place, open our hearts so that we may understand our call to follow Jesus more clearly. Help us to remember that that true strength is not found in displays of power, but rather in acts of mercy, love, and grace. *Amen.*
